

Draft RSE Award

Categories, evaluation criteria and indicators

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Abstract

test abstract

Keywords: keyword1; keyword2; keyword3; keyword4

1 Award categories

Category	Sub-Category	Format	Eligibility
Artefact Track	-	Open call	RS must have an artefact badge from a German or DACH conference
Scientific Excellence	Humanities and Social Sciences	Open call	1. RS must be published in a scientific peer-reviewed journal 2. Researchers must be affiliated with a German or DACH university/research institution
	Life Sciences		
	Natural Sciences		
	Engineering		
Newcomer	-	Open call	1. PhD (and master) students from a German or DACH university/research institution 2. Submission of motivation letter

Table 1: Award categories, format and eligibility criteria. RS = Research software

Open questions:

- Keeping Artefact Track as a separate category or not?
 - Could also be a requirement for the “Engineering” sub-category.
 - From all > 100 GI-Fachgruppen only two German/DACH conferences were found with an artefact evaluation track (DELFI 2026, BTW 2025)

2 Process/timeline

Conference/Public Call

Filtering

Short-list

Jury

Award Event

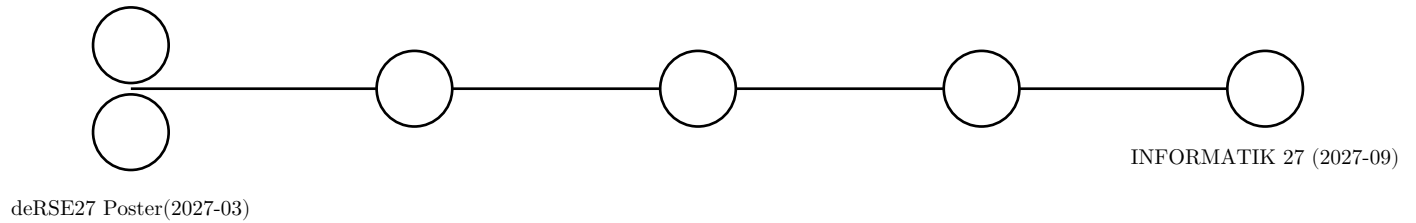


Figure 1: Process timeline of the RSE Award, from public call to award event

2.1 Scientific Excellence category

Conference/Public Call

Filtering

Short-list

Jury

Award Event

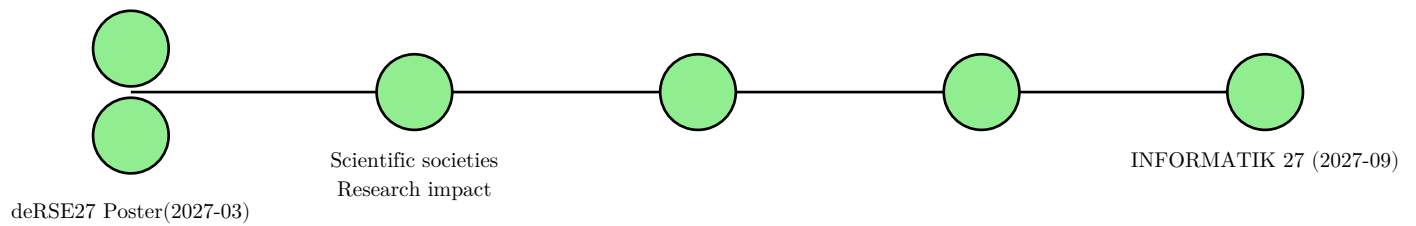


Figure 2: Process timeline for the Scientific Excellence category

Open questions:

- Process with scientific societies unclear

2.2 Newcomer category

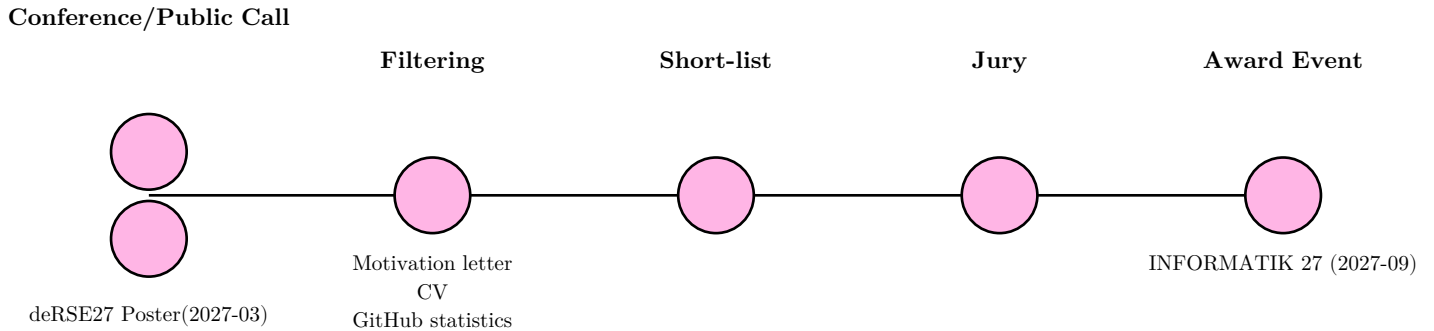


Figure 3: Process timeline for the Newcomer category

3 Filtering

Category	Filter Criteria	Filter Indicators
Artefact Track	-	-
Scientific Excellence	Scientific societies	
	Research impact	Number of citations, Number of paper downloads
		Ranking of the journal
Newcomer	Motivation letter	Relevance of RS for community
		CV
	Community Engagement, GitHub statistics	Stars, Forks, Watch
		Contributor growth, Pull requests
		Issues, Commit frequency

Table 2: Filter system

4 Jury composition & award ceremony

4.1 Jury composition

- “Scientific Excellence” category: Probably 1 jury for each sub-category (4 in total) -> domain knowledge important

- “Newcomer” category: a sample of the jury people from “Scientific Excellence” category
- How many people? Decision rules?
- Using evaluation system provided by us (see below)

List of relevant people for jury:

- [GI RSE Fachgruppe Leitungsgremium](#)
- deRSE conference orga team; see [deRSE26](#)
- [CORSES — Collaborative RSE Services project](#)
- [find.software project](#)
- [Ben Hermann](#), mentioned in a previous AK meeting

4.2 Award ceremony

- idea: INFORMATIK 27 (2027-09)
- invite someone from DFG; see [DFG Förderprogramm “Forschungssoftwareinfrastrukturen”](#)

5 Evaluation criteria and indicators

5.1 Artefact Track

	Software Engineering Level	Research Impact	Community Engagement	FAIRness & Reproducibility	Maintainability & Sustainability
Definition					
Indicators					
Sources					

Table 3: Evaluation criteria and indicators for the Artefact Track category

Each criterion is rated on an ordinal scale, from 1 (minimum) to 5 (outstanding).

5.2 Scientific Excellence

	Software Engineering Level	Research Impact	Community Engagement	FAIRness & Reproducibility	Maintainability & Sustainability
Definition					
Indicators					
Sources					

Table 4: Evaluation criteria and indicators for the Scientific Excellence category

Each criterion is rated on an ordinal scale, from 1 (minimum) to 5 (outstanding).

5.3 Newcomer

	Community Engagement	
Definition		
Indicators		
Sources		

Table 5: Evaluation criteria and indicators for the Newcomer category

Each criterion is rated on an ordinal scale, from 1 (minimum) to 5 (outstanding).

Appendix